A-A-53490
17 June 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

HUMIDIFIER, HYGROSCOPIC

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a disposable hygroscopic humidifier suitable for maintaining heat of and humidification of inspiratory gases during intensive care respiratory therapy or administration of anesthesia.

Salient characteristics:

The hygroscopic humidifier shall be a disposable, sterile respiratory therapy or anesthesia device suitable for maintaining heat of and humidification of inspiratory gases.

The humidifier shall consist basically of a cellulose sponge around a synthetic felt material designed to store heat and moisture before transferring it to the inspiratory gases.

The humidifier shall have a 15 mm internal diameter cone connector on the patient side and a 22 mm internal diameter cone connector on the equipment side. The humidifier may have a flexible tube on the patient side. All connectors shall meet ISO standards. The humidifier shall be bacteriostatic to reduce the risk of air-born infection.

The humidifier shall be packaged individually so as to maintain sterility until opened or damaged.

Packaging and labeling shall meet the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and shall be that usually furnished by the supplier as commercial practice. Addition to these labels shall be limited to application of the following to the unit of issue (strip labeling is acceptable):

a. National stock number (NSN)
b. Date of manufacture or expiration date (immediate container).
c. Date (month and year, i.e., 7/87) of packaging.
d. Bar code (when applicable).

AMSC N/A PSC 6515

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Workmanship. The hygroscopic humidifier shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred individually packaged sterile humidifiers, as specified, constitutes one unit. The individual package shall be capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless the package is damaged or opened.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one hygroscopic humidifier as specified in this description.

Defects.

Connectors on patient or equipment side not correct internal diameter, or, not meeting ISO standards.

Individual sterile package punctured or torn, voiding sterility.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for tests purposes shall be one hygroscopic humidifier.

Tests

Sterilization test. Sterilization testing shall be in accordance with the FDA'S current "Guideline on General Principles of Process Validation".

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

6515-01-256-4963

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PBS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4260

PGC 70071

Location: CID/HUMIDIFIER/H13-22

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-[redacted] RSTE
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53490	HUMIDIFIER, HYGROSCOPIC

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.